but quite compatible in a broad sense with tianxia. Revolutionary tributaries, even if they were not communists, would come to Russia and China for inspiration, legitimacy, and help to oust Western colonial powers and local ruling classes. Eventually, a Russian- or Chinese-led global revolutionary struggle would confront world capitalism and its defenders, mostly Western powers.

Great Power

The third source of thinking about China's place in the world is its Great Power view. Perhaps the most celebrated statements of this view are the trilogy by a former interpreter of Deng Xiaoping and now a professor of international relations at Fudan University, Zhang Weiwei. Beginning with a book in Mandarin (which is not available in English), he published three books for a Chinese audience, two of which he then translated for a wider audience – *The China Wave* in 2012 and *The China Horizon* in 2016. The former book is emblazoned with the claim that it sold more than half a million copies in China. The subtitles of the two books are triumphalist: 'Rise of a Civilizational State' and 'Glory and Dream of a Civilizational State'. Zhang celebrates China's arrival as a Great Power, indeed as the greatest power on earth: the first chapter in *The China Horizon* is called 'From Catching-up to Surpassing' – that is, surpassing the current greatest power, the US.[100]

Summarizing his trilogy, Zhang can hardly contain himself: 'Concerning China's rise, my primary viewpoint is that the rise of China is that of a civilizational state, and it is the world's longest continuous civilization amalgamated with a huge modern state. This civilizational state has at least eight features, namely, a super-large population, a super-vast territory, super-long traditions, super-rich culture, a unique language, unique politics, a unique society and a unique economy'.[101] This breathless description, almost every part of which is contestable for its truth-value, nevertheless captures a widespread if not always publicly articulated view: most Chinese